

roads and bridges to stitch the state together. It's a magnificent blueprint for a Bihar that dares to dream big. For instance, the medical colleges include upgrades in districts like Siwan and Saran, addressing a doctor-patient ratio that once languished at 1:17,000. The sports complexes, like the one planned in Patna, echo the state's push to reclaim its sporting legacy—think of cricketer Ishan Kishan, a Bihari lad who's made waves in the IPL.

A BIRTHDAY BOOST ON BIHAR DAY

The timing couldn't have been more appropriate. The Pragati Yatra culminated just as Bihar geared up for its annual statehood celebration, Bihar Day, on 22 March. On 22 March 1912, after sustained efforts by leaders like Sachchidananda Sinha and Mahesh Narayan against colonial inertia, Bihar was carved out from Bengal, gaining its own administrative identity. What began as a quest for recognition has, over a century later, morphed into a mission for redemption.

Once the cradle of empires—Magadha, the Mauryas, and the Guptas, whose capital Pataliputra (modern Patna) was a global marvel—Bihar fell into a post-independence slumber. Poverty, poor infrastructure, and lawlessness defined its narrative for decades. According to the Planning Commission report, Bihar's per capita income during the 1990s was around ₹5,000–₹6,500, significantly lower than the national average of ₹10,000–₹12,000 at the time. The Pragati Yatra has lent this year's Bihar Day an extra sheen, a reminder that the state is no longer content to linger in the shadows of its past. This year, the 113th anniversary of Bihar's separation from the Bengal Presidency felt different—charged with a renewed sense of purpose. The CM's ambitious announcements have turned a commemorative date into a launchpad for progress, amplifying the festivities with tangible hope.

Nitish Kumar's tenure since 2005 has been punctuated by bold moves. Law and order was his first triumph–once a land where daylight robberies, murders and kidnappings were rampant, Bihar saw crime rates plummet as police stations were revitalised.

SHEDDING THE TAG OF BACKWARDNESS

Rewind to 2005. Bihar was a state on its knees—roads were potholed nightmares, schools were hollow shells, and power cuts were a way of life. Enter Nitish Kumar, a soft-spoken engineer-turned-politician with a steely resolve. Taking the reins after years of political chaos under predecessors whose tenure saw infrastructure crumble while caste politics thrived—he vowed to erase the backward state label. His early years were a whirlwind of reform: law and order tightened, roads sprang up like arteries, and electricity began to flicker into homes. Historians will debate his legacy, but the numbers don't lie—Bihar's transformation over the past two decades is palpable.

The Pragati Yatra is the latest chapter in this saga.

NITISH KUMAR'S PROGRESS JOURNEY BRINGS A WAVE OF DEVELOPMENT TO BIHAR A GIFT OF 50,000 CRORE

During Chief Minister Nitish Kumar's Pragati Yatra, Bihar has received a significant boost with development projects worth 50,000 crore. As part of this initiative, crucial announcements have been made across various sectors for all 38 districts of the state, marking a milestone in Bihar's comprehensive development.

Category	Number	Districts
Medical Colleges	10	Darbhanga, Samastipur, Khagaria, Supaul, Araria, Banka, Nawada, Aurangabad, Jehanabad, Kaimur
Degree Colleges	7	Gopalganj (Vaishali), Buxar, Banka, Nawada, West Champaran, Jehanabad, Kaimur
Power Grids	9	West Champaran, Sitamarhi-Sheohar, Vaishali, Sheohar, Madhepura, Banka, Raxaul-Sheikhpura, Nawada
Religious Tourism	17	Kaimur, East Champaran, Gopalganj, Vaishali, Madhubani, Samastipur, Buxar, Kishanganj, Saharsa, Katihar, Munger, Raxaul, Jehanabad, Aurangabad, Rohtas, Nalanda
Industrial Development	11	Bhagalpur, West Champaran, East Champaran, Gopalganj, Vaishali, Madhepura, Buxar, Munger, Nawada, Darbhanga, Madhubani
Airports	5	Darbhanga, Madhubani, Supaul, Saharsa, Bhagalpur
Eco-Tourism	1	Nalanda
Sports Complexes	10	Buxar, Kaimur, West Champaran, Saharsa, Purnia, Jamui, Aurangabad, Jehanabad, Arwal, Nalanda

This ambitious initiative is expected to accelerate Bihar's infrastructure, education, and industrial growth, reinforcing the state's journey towards progress.